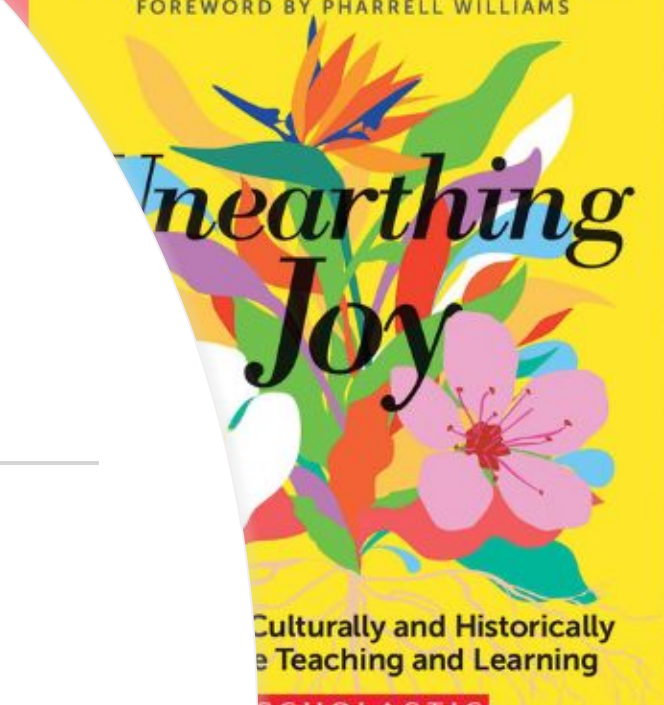




Week 3: Towards the Pursuit of Joy



The Power of Playful Learning in the Early Childhood Setting

**The *false dichotomy* between
play and learning**

**Pedegogy of Plkay (PoP)
Framework :
*Play on a Spectrum***

**Challenges to Play in Early
Childhood Education:
*The rise of accountability and
high-stakes testing***





Activating Joy Through Culturally and Historically Responsive Read-Alouds

Key Concept: The Pursuit of Joy in Literacy Instruction

Joy is more than a fleeting feeling

Culturally Responsive Read-Alouds: Teachers and students co-construct knowledge by sharing stories from multiple perspectives.

Read-alouds promote *global citizenship*

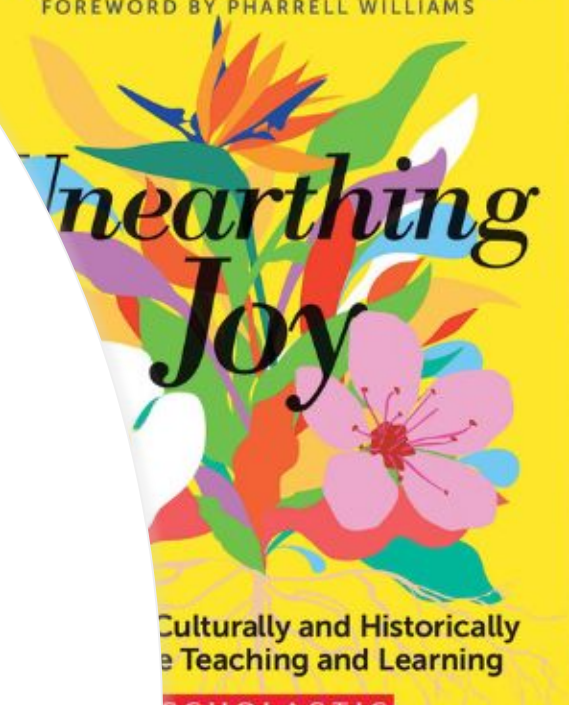
**Joy as Social Action:
Joy becomes a transformative force when educators move beyond skill-based learning**

**What does it mean to be Happy?
To experience joy?**



Center Joy in Education

- Cultivate joy to realize dreams
- Joy inspires all other pursuits





Guide Students

- **Teachers are constellations, guiding students**
- **Students are limitless**



Joy and Agency

- Joy helps students uncover their genius
- Agency leads to being fully human

Cultivating Genius and the 5 pursuits

- **Responsive teaching nurtures genius**
- **Every child is a genius**





Standards vs. Pursuits

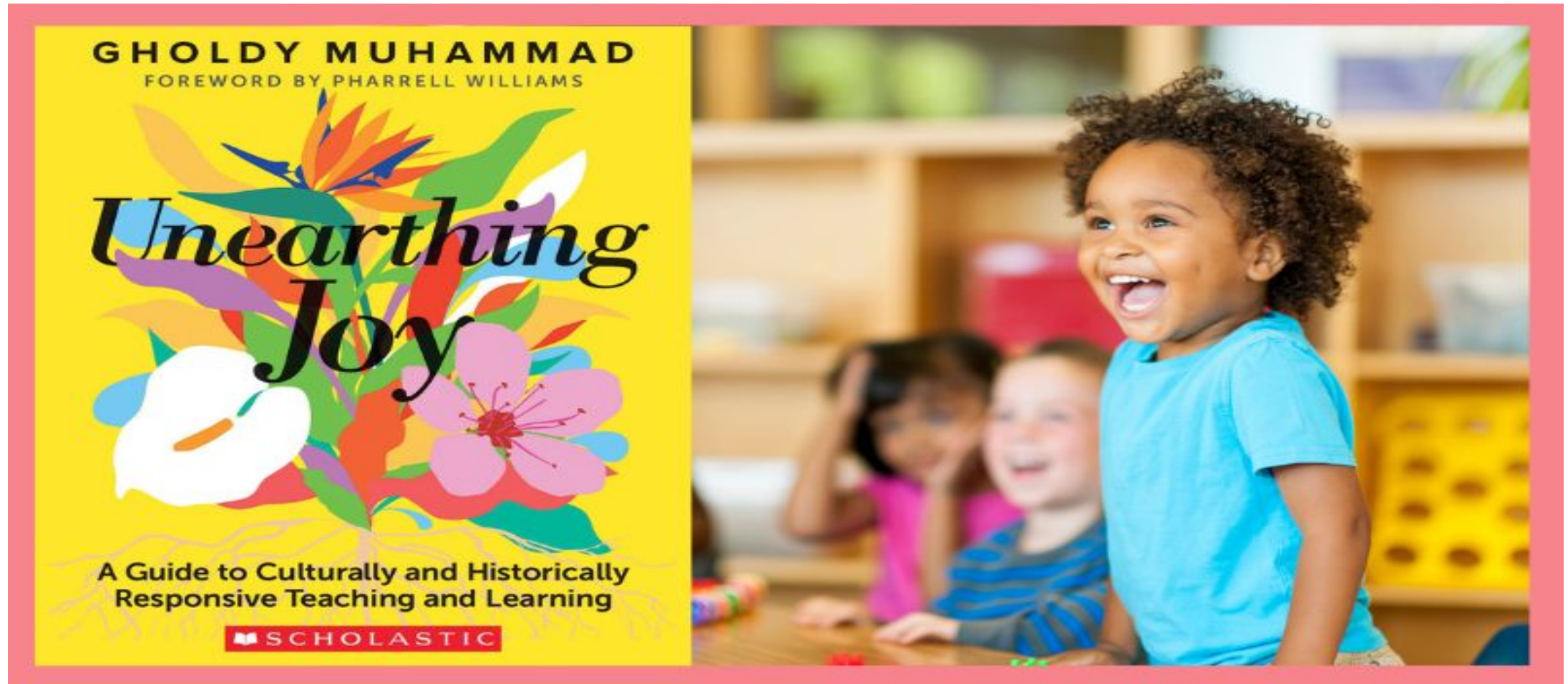
- **Pursuits continue for life**
- **Standards cap learning**



Nurturing Joy and Genius

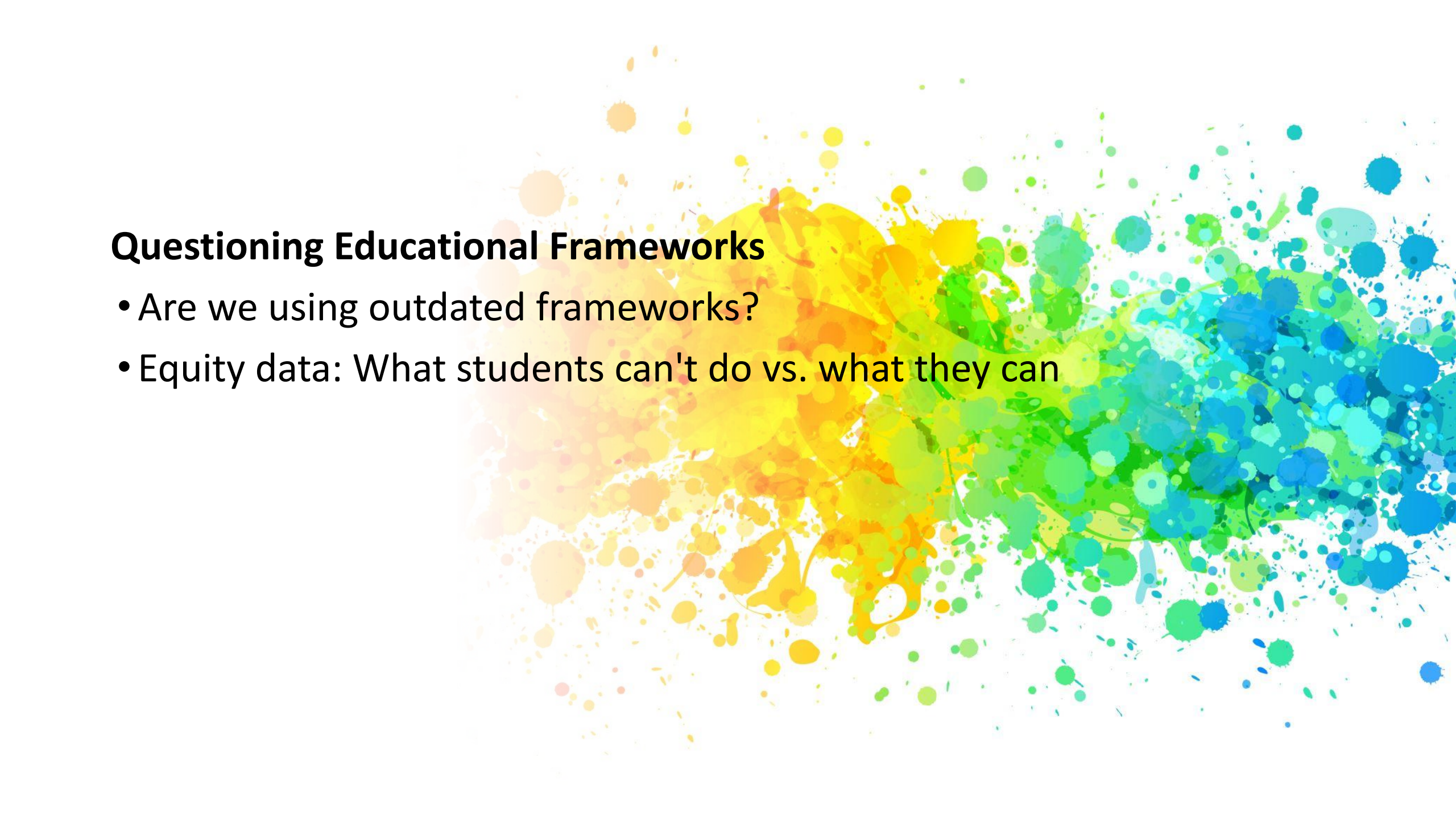
- Don't uproot students, nourish them
- Genius and joy create a lasting legacy

Chapter 1



Curate Musical Choice

I wish I knew how it would feel to be free - Nina Simone ▶ Nina Simone - I Wish I ...	Alabama - John coletran ▶ Alabama	Whats going on- Marvin Gaye ▶ Marvin Gaye - What's ...
Let up- Abby Lincoln ▶ Let Up (Remastered)	State of the world -Janet Jackson ▶ Janet Jackson - State ...	Gimme mine- Tall black guy ▶ Gimme Mine (feat. 80's...
Conversation Peace - Stevie Wonder ▶ Conversation Peace	If I rule the world imagine that Nas featuring Lauryn Hill ▶ Nas - If I Ruled the Wor...	Blowing in the wind..... Bob Dylan ▶ 🎵 Bob Dylan - Blowin' I...



Questioning Educational Frameworks

- Are we using outdated frameworks?
- Equity data: What students can't do vs. what they can



Defining True Equity

- **Equity is more than access**
- **Centered on justice, liberation, and truth**

A History of Genius, Justice, and Joy

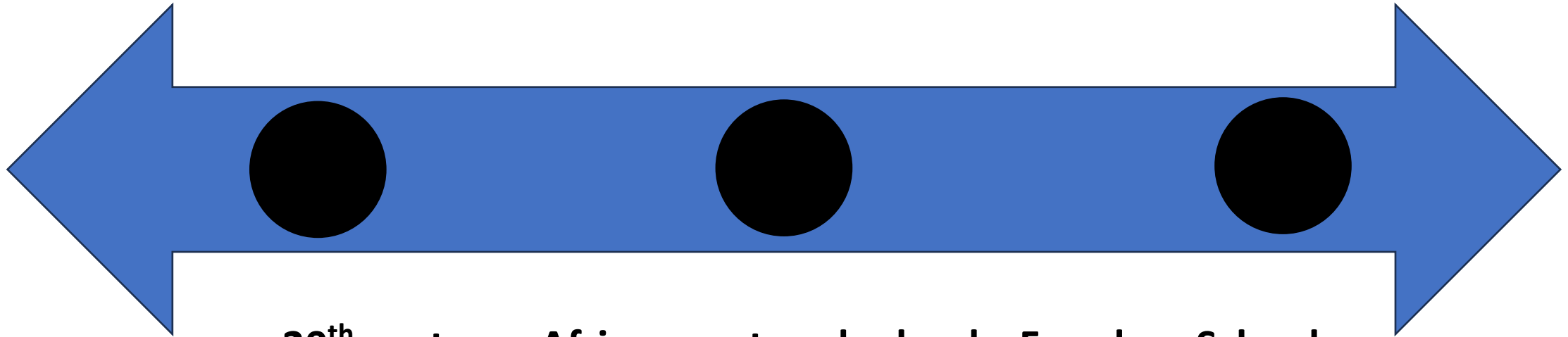
- Genius and liberation through history
- Braided maps and coded songs as routes to freedom



Timeline of Model Learning Space

19th century: Hush Harbors, literary societies and anti slavery and abolitionists

21st century examples ?



**20th century : African centered schools, Freedom Schools,
Hip Hop Pedegogy**

Erasure of Genius and Justice

- Standardized testing ignores multiple literacies
- Curriculum reflects standardized practices





Need for New Educational Pursuits

- **Beyond state standards: The 5 pursuits**
- **Reframe skills, connect to students' lives**



Educators Need New Pursuits Too

- Identity, Skills, Intellect, Criticality, Joy
- For both students and educators

Recontextualizing Curriculum

- Reframe the standards to the 5 pursuits
- Joy as a central pursuit

